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Noise Reducing Water Resistant Headpiece

Abstract

A covering apparatus having a unitary material. The unitary material has a grip disposed around the interior perimeter of the material. The grip is fused to the material wherein the grip enables the material to provide a water tight seal and wherein the material is covering an object without slipping and sliding off the object. The material has an elastic member which is enclosed in the material which is located in the rear of the covering apparatus.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/965,532 filed Oct. 13, 2022, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/032,855 filed Jul. 11, 2018, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/837,063 filed Aug. 27, 2015 and now granted as U.S. Pat. No. 10,021,930, which is a continuation-in-part of U.S. Design patent application Ser. No. 29/504,909 filed Oct. 10, 2014 and now granted as U.S. Design Patent No. D775,792, the contents of each of which are hereby incorporated by reference herein.

FIELD OF THE EMBODIMENTS

[0002] The invention and its embodiments relate to a shower cap with improved properties. In particular, a shower cap that provides a more relaxing shower experience by reducing the volume experienced by a user of said shower cap.

BACKGROUND OF THE EMBODIMENTS

[0003] Conventional head coverings and apparatuses are known in the art and date back many years. Specifically, a shower cap (also known as a bath cap) is a hat worn while showering or bathing to protect hair from becoming wet. Alternatively, shower caps for children can resemble crowns with wide brims, preventing water and shampoo from getting in a user's eyes while allowing the hair to be washed.

[0004] Many of these caps are created by merging two layers of fabric, one that is water impermeable, and one that is decorated. This allows a shower cap to retard the spread of water, all while being visually pleasing. While this two-fabric design works well, simpler designs of shower caps are made from a single layer of a waterproof material. Regardless of the amount layers in the cap, these designs invariably contain some elastic edging, used to keep them in place.

[0005] Shower baths grew in popularity around the same time that daily bathing became ubiquitous with society. Reports show that while the authorities of the time viewed daily bathing favorably, whether or not daily hair-washing was helpful was unclear. This uncertainty spurred the creation of the “extinguisher cap,” a pointy oilcloth hat worn by bathers in the Regency-era. These caps were designed to protect a bather's hair while shielding them from the new experience of water continuously falling on their heads from above.

[0006] By the 1880's the “extinguisher cap” began to disappear and the modern shower cap began to enter the folds of mainstream society. Since 1950's traditional shower cap construction stayed the same. The present invention applies lingerie and performance advancements to a space that has traditionally had no technological innovation in the last 50 plus years.

Review of Related Apparatus and Methods:

[0007] U.S. Pat. No. 8,316,466 discloses a secure-fitting and absorbent elongated hood for containing, managing, and drying wet hair and preventing water from dripping onto flooring or onto the wearer's clothing during the hair drying or hair setting process, requiring no leaning forward of the head for application. Such elongated hood generally comprises an absorbent concave form-fitting cap having a centering button located thereon, a triangular wing of fabric extending from each of the left and right sides of said form-fitting cap of said elongated hood, reciprocal hook-and-loop fabric strips sewn onto each left and right triangular wing, an elongated tail region being progressively tapered from said concave form-fitting cap to a rounded and concave distal end and having an elastic loop for fastening purposes, and concave petal-shaped protuberances of absorbent fabric at such concave distal end for catching, retaining, and absorbing water dripping from the wearer's hair.

[0008] U.S. Pat. No. 7,412,729 discloses a device that covers the head of an individual. It consists of a towel, a strip of elastic, a set of strips and a pocket. The pocket within the device allows an individual to insert his or her hair into the device. The individual then tightly twists the end of the towel with the pocket and the end of the towel with the pocket is secured with the tie strips. A piece of elastic allows some flexibility with the device to ensure that the device will fit all heads and to insure the comfort of the wearer.

[0009] U.S. Pat. No. 6,560,784 teaches a multi-layered moisture resistant hair wrap surrounds a person's entire head of hair protecting, maintaining, and prolonging a hairstyle and adapted to do so in moist environments that include water, steam, mist and humidity and absorbing moisture generated from heat or perspiration from one's scalp.

[0010] U.S. Pat. No. 6,189,152 teaches a bathing cap that includes lower extensions which can wrap around the sides of the cap, cross at the top, wrap down around the sides, and tie at the nape of the neck. Preferably, the portions of the cap adjacent the cheeks project forward of the normal hairline.

[0011] U.S. Pat. No. 5,365,613A hair drying turban made from a single piece of absorbent cloth and having a cap portion and, extending forwardly, a hair basket portion. In use, the wearer places the cap portion on his or her hair with the hair extending forwardly over the forehead and face (the wearer bending at the waist). Then, with the hair placed neatly within the hair basket portion, the hair basket is twisted about the longitudinal axis of the hair. The hair basket portion is then folded backwardly along the center line of the cap portion and secured to the back of the cap portion. A loop is provided for allowing the turban to be easily hung on a door peg and/or, alternatively, to facilitate the tucking in of the hair basket portion beneath the cap portion.

[0012] U.S. Patent Publication No. 2007/0056079 teaches a long cap for protecting the hair, of elongate form, formed from two lateral walls of parallelepipedal shape fixed to one another along one of their long sides and one of their two small sides so as to delimit a first pocket arranged at the proximal end of the long cap, forming a cap, and a second pocket arranged at the distal end of the long cap and forming a receptacle for the floating mass of hair, and whose two ends are provided with complementary fastening means that can be placed in contact in order to close the long cap around the head after the hair has been placed in the cap, turning the distal end through 180° about the longitudinal axis of the long cap and then folding this distal end down in order to cover the proximal end.

[0013] U.S. Patent Publication No. 2013/0298929 discloses a hair protection cap according to the present disclosure includes a bag forming an interior channel having an inside surface and outside surface, the interior channel having a first opening and a second opening opposite the first opening. A first opening reducing device enables the expansion and contraction of a size of a perimeter of the first opening and a second opening reducing device enables closing of the second opening. The inside surface of the bag is a pliable material and the outside surface of the bag is a pliable water-resistant material, the pliable water-resistant material extending over the perimeter of the first opening on the inside surface of the bag.

[0014] U.S. Patent Publication No. 2013/0247269 teaches a decorative swim/bath/shower tuque worn by a swimmer/bather/showerer, respectively, having voluminous hair with a length. The decorative swim/bath/shower tuque has dual lengths so as to adjust to the length of the voluminous hair of the swimmer/bather/showerer. The decorative swim/bath/shower tuque includes a sleeve, a dome, and a folded brim. The sleeve has a lower end and an upper end, and is worn by the swimmer/bather/showerer. The dome closes the upper end of the sleeve. The folded brim defines the lower end of the sleeve, and has the dual lengths so as to adjust the sleeve to the length of the voluminous hair of the swimmer/bather/showerer.

[0015] Various apparatuses and devices are known in the art. However, their structure and means of operation are substantially different from the present invention. Such traditional apparatuses and devices fail to provide a means for creating a secure grip, noise reducing and also fail to provide a

fashionable silhouette. At least one embodiment of this invention is presented in the drawings below, and will be described in more detail herein.

SUMMARY OF THE EMBODIMENTS

[0016] The present invention provides for a covering apparatus having a unitary material. The unitary material adapted and configured with a grip disposed around the interior perimeter of the material. The grip is fused to the material wherein the grip enables the material to provide a water tight seal and wherein the material is covering an object without slipping and sliding off the object. The material is adapted and configured with an elastic member which is enclosed in the material which is located in the rear of the covering apparatus. In another embodiment the elastic member may not be enclosed in a material. In another embodiment, the elastic member may be located around the interior edges of the covering apparatus.

[0017] The covering apparatus further having material which enables the covering apparatus to be secured over a plurality of objects. The material is comprised of a fabric. The fabric is adapted and configured with a poly urethane backing. The material has a durable water repellent coating which is applied to the fabric. This makes the material hydrophobic and has a nanotechnology component. The grip is comprised of rubber, neoprene or any material which may provide a secure and water tight functionality. The material is adapted and configured to be water resistant. The materials is digitally sublimated with a plurality of designs. The grip is stitched, bonded or piped on to the material. The material is adapted and configured to include a plastic liner disposed on the entire inside of the material. This may mean that the plastic liner is fused to the entire inside of the material. The material is either knit or woven. The exterior of the material is multiply folded on each side wherein said folds culminate into a point. The covering apparatus may comprise a turban.

[0018] It is an object of the present invention that the covering apparatus may be used as a shower cap.

[0019] It is an object of the present invention that the covering apparatus may be used to protect the hair from coming into contact with water.

[0020] It is an object of the present invention that the covering apparatus is able to reduce the noise heard by an individual wearing the shower cap as compared to a plastic shower cap.

[0021] It is an object of the present invention that the covering apparatus may be used to cover golf clubs, surgical and sanitary hair coverings or as a fashion accessory.

[0022] It is an object of the present invention that the fabric is antibacterial and machine washable.

[0023] It is an object of the present invention that the material comprises a pocket for enclosing hair.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0024] FIG. 1 is a perspective view of the present invention.

[0025] FIG. 2 is a front perspective view of the present invention.

[0026] FIG. 3 is a rear view of the present invention.

[0027] FIG. 4 is a right side view of the present invention.

[0028] FIG. 5 is a left side view of the present invention.

[0029] FIG. 6 is a top view of the present invention.

[0030] FIG. 7 is a bottom view of the present invention.

[0031] FIG. 8 is a perspective view of the present invention as worn by an individual in accordance with the present invention.

[0032] FIG. 9 is an alternative view of the present invention.

[0033] FIG. 10 is an alternative view showing the inside of the present invention.

[0034] FIG. 11 shows a perspective view of the fabric pre fold of the present invention.

[0035] FIG. 12 shows a perspective view of the fabric post fold of the present invention FIG. 13 shows an illustrative view of the water resistant fabric of the present invention.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

[0036] The preferred embodiments of the present invention will now be described with reference to the drawings. Identical elements in the various figures are identified with the same reference numerals.

[0037] Reference will now be made in detail to each embodiment of the present invention. Such embodiments are provided by way of explanation of the present invention, which is not intended to be limited thereto. In fact, those of ordinary skill in the art may appreciate upon reading the present specification and viewing the present drawings that various modifications and variations can be made thereto.

[0038] While this disclosure refers to exemplary embodiments, it will be understood by those skilled in the art that various changes may be made and equivalents may be substituted for elements thereof without departing from the scope of the disclosure. In addition, many modifications will be appreciated by those skilled in the art to adapt a particular instrument, situation or material to the teachings of the disclosure without departing from the spirit thereof. Therefore, it is intended that the disclosure not be limited to the particular embodiments disclosed.

[0039] Referring to FIG. 1, an embodiment of the present invention is shown. Here, shower cap **100** is shaped similarly to a turban, in that it provides complete coverage of the hair-producing areas of a user's scalp. In addition to the unique shape of the shower cap **100**, shower cap **100** features a back pocket. That is, shower cap **100** is equipped with an additional amount of fabric, breaking from the standard contours of shower cap **100**. This additional fabric allows for users with large amounts of hair, or with unique hairstyles to still avail themselves of the benefits of the present invention.

[0040] In a preferred embodiment, shower cap **100** is comprised of a material that is water-repellent. In another preferred embodiment, this material is fabric. While many suitable fabrics exist, the ideal fabric will be one that is antimicrobial and water resistant. While a fabric that is coated with an antimicrobial agent is suitable, one that is inherently antimicrobial, such as fabrics that contain aluminum or tin are preferable, as their antimicrobial properties will not fade with time. Natural and synthetic latex are a particularly suitable materials for this purpose. This makes the fabric hydrophobic and has a nanotechnology component.

[0041] In yet another preferred embodiment, the present invention is a dual-layer variant wherein said inner layer is constructed out of polyurethane, and the outer layer is constructed out of a material that is coated with durable water repellent coating. The resulting fabric appears to be one layer to the consumer. There are many proprietary suitable durable water repellents, sold by vendors such as Grangers, Nikwas, McNett, Trek7. Alternatively, a single fabric variant can be used, where the durable water repellent coating is disposed directly on the knit or woven face of the fabric. Preferably, the fabric will be breathable so that the user wearing the covering apparatus does not get too hot or a humid environment is not created and thus acts to prevent hair frizz. In an alternative embodiment, shower cap **100** is machine washable. In yet another alternative embodiment, shower cap **100** is disposable.

[0042] Shower cap **100** has auditory dampening effects. Standard plastic shower caps, when in use, create sound with a volume of 84 decibels (dB) on average, reaching as high as 90 dB. In contrast, shower cap **100** creates sound with a volume of 82 dB on average, and only gets as high as 85 dB. Plastic shower caps create snapping loud sounds whereas the present invention creates a more soothing type of noise which creates a more relaxing experience for those wearing the covering apparatus.

[0043] FIGS. 2-8 show the same embodiment of the present invention as FIG. 1, and therefore contain the same features disclosed therein.

[0044] As illustrated in FIG. 8, the shower cap **100** includes a front section **100a** configured for

being placed onto a forehead of a head of the wearer and a further section **100b**, which is configured for being placed over the hair of the wearer. The covering layer **106**, formed by layers **101**, **105**, includes multiple folds **107a**, **107b** in at least a front section **100a** of the shower cap **100**. The multiple folds **107a**, **107b** radiate outward from a flat portion **108** of the band **103** of the shower cap **100**. The multiple folds **107a**, **107b** consist of three folds **107a** on one side of a medial vertically-extending center plane **109** and three folds **107b** on the other side of the medial vertically-extending center plane **109**. Each of the multiple folds **107a**, **107b** comprises a peak **110** and a valley **111** between adjacent peaks **110**. The valley **111** is open in a direction away from the head of the wearer when worn.

[0045] Referring to FIG. **9**, a front view of an embodiment of the present invention is shown. Here, shower cap **100** features outer layer **101**, gathered band **102**, and elongated band **103**. In one embodiment, gathered band **102** and elongated band **103** are of a unitary construction.

[0046] Preferably, gathered band **102** and elongated band **103** are constructed out of an elastic material. This allows shower cap **100** to be snugly attached to a user's head. This prevent accidental slip-offs, which is important, because if a user's hair is subjected to water while using the cap, the purpose of using the present invention is largely defeated. Further, outer layer **101** may have ornamentation disposed thereon. That is, various patterns or images may be printed on the outer layer **101**. In some embodiments, this ornamentation is disposed prior to the application of the durable water repellant, and in other embodiments, the ornamentation is disposed after the application of the durable water repellant. Preferably, outer layer **101** is comprised of a material that stretches, providing the user with greater comfort while using shower cap **100**. In another embodiment, the material does not have to be stretchable.

[0047] In FIG. **10**, another view of an embodiment of shower cap **100** is provided for. Here, shower cap **100** features grip **104**, gathered band **102**, and inner layer **105**. It should be noted that while preferable, the inclusion of grip **104** is purely optional. Preferably, grip **104** is constructed out of rubber. In another embodiment, the grip can be made from any material, such as fabric or neoprene such that the grip can provide a water sealing effect while providing a mechanism for non-slippage. Inner layer **105** can be constructed out of any fabric, but something stretchable is desired, particularly if the two-layer variant is being utilized. Inner layer **105** may also be disposed with ornamentation such as patterns or illustrations.

[0048] In some embodiments, the gathered band **102** is thicker, so that a snugger grip may be achieved. In one embodiment, inner layer **105** is disposed with dry shampoo or a scented agent. This will enable a user's hair to be refreshed while using shower cap **100**.

[0049] FIGS. **11** and **12** show two embodiments of attachments of the two-layer variants. FIG. **11** shows an embodiment where the two layers are adhered together. FIG. **12** shows an embodiment where the two layers are folded over one another and subsequently joined.

[0050] In FIG. **13**, the water-repellant nature of shower cap **100** is shown.

[0051] In yet another embodiment, the present invention is equipped with a drawstring so that it may double as a makeup bag for travel.

[0052] When introducing elements of the present disclosure or the embodiment(s) thereof, the articles “a,” “an,” and “the” are intended to mean that there are one or more of the elements. Similarly, the adjective “another,” when used to introduce an element, is intended to mean one or more elements. The terms “including” and “having” are intended to be inclusive such that there may be additional elements other than the listed elements.

[0053] Therefore, it is intended that the disclosure not be limited to the particular embodiments disclosed.

Claims

- 1.** A covering apparatus comprising: a unitary material; said material adapted and configured with a grip disposed around the interior perimeter of the material: said grip being fused to said material; wherein the grip enables the material to provide a water tight seal wherein the material is covering an object without slipping and sliding off the object; said materials adapted and configured with an elastic member which is enclosed in the material which is located in the rear of the covering apparatus.
 - 2.** The covering apparatus of claim 1 wherein the material enables the covering apparatus to be secured over a plurality of objects.
 - 3.** The covering apparatus of claim 1, wherein the elastic member is not enclosed in the material.
 - 4.** The covering apparatus of claim 1, wherein the elastic member is located around the interior edges of the covering apparatus.
 - 5.** The covering apparatus of claim 1 wherein the material is comprised of a fabric.
 - 6.** The covering apparatus of claim 1 wherein the fabric is adapted and configured with a poly urethane backing.
 - 7.** The covering apparatus of claim 1 wherein the material is hydrophobic, durable water repellent fabric, and has a nanotechnology component.
 - 8.** The covering apparatus of claim 1 wherein the grip is comprised of rubber, neoprene or any material which may provide a water tight seal.
 - 9.** The covering apparatus of claim 1, wherein the material is adapted and configured to be water resistant.
 - 10.** The covering apparatus of claim 1 wherein the materials is digitally sublimated with a plurality of designs.
 - 11.** The covering apparatus of claim 1, wherein the grip is stitched, bonded or piped to the material.
 - 12.** The covering apparatus of claim 1 wherein the covering apparatus is a shower cap.
 - 13.** A covering apparatus of claim 1 wherein the covering apparatus is able to reduce the noise heard by an individual wearing the shower cap.
 - 14.** The covering apparatus of claim 1 wherein the covering apparatus is used to cover golf clubs, hair or as a fashion accessory.
 - 15.** The covering apparatus of claim 1 wherein the material is adapted and configured to include a plastic liner disposed on the entire inside of the material.
 - 16.** The covering apparatus of claim 1 wherein the material is adapted and configured to include a plastic liner fused on the entire inside of the material.
 - 17.** The covering apparatus of claim 1 wherein the material is either knit or woven.
 - 18.** The covering apparatus of claim 1 wherein the exterior of the material is multiply folded on each side wherein said folds culminate into a point.
 - 19.** The covering apparatus of claim 1, wherein the covering apparatus is used for surgical and hair sanitary purposes.
 - 20.** The covering apparatus of claim 1, wherein the material comprises a pocket for enclosing hair.
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